

PRAGYA ARYAL

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EDUCATION

HERALD COLLEGE KATHMANDU (*Affiliated with University of Wolverhampton, UK*)

Kathmandu, Nepal
2025

BSC Computer Science (Hons)

GPA: 3.81/4.0

Relevant Coursework: Big Data; AI & ML; Computational Mathematics; Project & Professionalism

PROJECT

GENDER-SENSITIVE HATE SPEECH DETECTION MODEL

- Developed hate speech classification models using TF-IDF, SVM, NepaliBERT, RoBERTa, and LoRA-based fine-tuning for Nepali political text.
- Used Python, Scikit-learn, Pandas, NLP pipelines, and Hugging Face Transformers for text preprocessing, model training, and comparative analysis.

COMPARATIVE ANALYSIS OF PUBLIC SPACE IN KATHMANDU AND NYC

- Conducted literature reviews, stakeholder interviews, and field research on public space accessibility and social use.
- Coordinated meetings with researchers and community stakeholders to gather qualitative data.

WEBSITE FOR A FEMINIST CAMPAIGN

- Designed and developed the website using HTML, CSS, and JavaScript to improve digital accessibility and user experience.
- Collaborated with stakeholders to translate organizational needs into a responsive design and managed content structure to enhance engagement.

WORK EXPERIENCE

NEW YORK CITY DEPARTMENT OF TRANSPORTATION (NYC DOT)

New York City, USA

CityGAP Fellow

Feb 2026 – Present (until May 2026)

- Serve as point person with the NYC DOT Urban Design Team to gamify the Street Design Manual in collaboration with the Living City Project
- Coordinate and lead meetings with inter-agency departments and stakeholders
- Manage and guide Living City Project gap year students through the game development process as Project Manager

SUMANA SHRESTHA SECRETARIAT

Kathmandu, Nepal

Digital Communication Fellow (*Secretariat of the Former Education Minister of Nepal*)

Jan 2023 – Aug 2025

- Created and managed branding and content, growing TikTok and Instagram to 100K+ organic followers over 2+ years.
- Simplified complex political jargon into relatable content, engaging over 80% of followers under 30.
- Utilized data analytics and insights from social media platforms to plan and ideate engagement strategies.

WOMEN IN INFORMATION & TECHNOLOGY (WIIT)

Kathmandu, Nepal

Data Enumerator (Research Project with The Asia Foundation)

Mar 2024 – Apr 2024

- Collected and compiled organizational and individual data for the research study “Women in ICTs: Current Status and Work Provisions in Nepal”
- Engaged with diverse participants respectfully and ensured accuracy and integrity of field data supporting impactful policymaking and research outcome

AFRISTEM

Capetown, South Africa

Apprentice | Curriculum Developer lead

Sept 2023 - Dec 2023

- Led the project of designing a comprehensive 12-hour web development module and its teaching manual, aimed at assisting high school and college graduates in securing jobs in frontend development
- Created a beginner-friendly Scratch coding e-book tailored for middle school students in low-income areas
- Designed the organization's logo, email signature, and letterhead; Initiated and managed social media platforms, gaining 80+ followers and over 300% engagement in a month

ADDITIONAL

Languages: Working proficiency in English, Nepali, and Hindi

Technical Skills: Python (Pandas, Scikit-learn, MATLAB), HTML, CSS, JavaScript, SQL, Figma

Other Skills: Research, storytelling, digital communication & branding, data analysis, and website development